

Daily Content Intel

June 24, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, here's the thing about blowing out a knee. The big force lands when you decelerate, when you plant that foot to cut or stop and your muscles have to soak up all of it at once. That soaking up is eccentric work, the muscle lengthening under load, and if your brakes are weak the ligament ends up taking the hit.

So researchers took professional team sport athletes in late-stage ACL recovery and split them into two groups, one doing traditional strength work and one doing eccentric-oriented strength work, 2 to 3 sessions a week for 6 weeks.

The eccentric group won across the board. Bigger gains in leg strength, in vertical jump, and in the single-leg and triple hop tests on the surgical leg, with effect sizes they called large to very large.

Here's what I do with my football and lacrosse guys. We train the lowering. Slow the descent on squats and split squats, 3 to 4 seconds down. We add real deceleration drills, sprint and stick the stop, cut and hold the landing. And we hammer single-leg strength, because the field never asks you to land on two feet.

You don't have to be hurt to train this. Strong brakes are how you stay on the field in the first place.

And honestly this carries over to active adults. Walking down stairs, stepping off a curb, that's all your brakes working. Build them and the knee

complains a lot less.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Most ACL tears happen the moment you plant and slow down to cut.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, here's the thing about blowing out a knee. The big force lands when you decelerate, when you plant that foot to cut or stop and your muscles have to soak up all of it at once. That soaking up is eccentric work, the muscle lengthening under load, and if your brakes are weak the ligament ends up taking the hit.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 ACL tears happen on the brakes
- 0:08 Deceleration = eccentric load
- 0:20 Eccentric vs traditional, 6 weeks, 2-3x/week

- 0:32 Eccentric won: strength, jump, hop tests
- 0:44 Train the lowering: 3-4 sec down
- 0:54 Deceleration drills + single-leg
- 1:06 Strong brakes keep you on the field

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Most ACL tears happen on the brakes, the instant an athlete plants to cut or stop. That force gets absorbed eccentrically, the muscle lengthening under load, and weak brakes hand the job to the ligament.

In one study of professional team-sport athletes in late-stage ACL recovery, 6 weeks of eccentric-oriented strength training (2 to 3 sessions a week) beat traditional strength work in leg strength, vertical jump, and single-leg and triple hop tests on the surgical leg, with large to very large effect sizes.

What that looks like in my gym with football and lacrosse athletes: slow the lowering on squats and split squats (3 to 4 seconds down), add deceleration drills where you sprint and stick the stop, and build single-leg strength because the field never asks you to

land on two feet. You don't have to be hurt to train your brakes. That's how you stay on the field.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT Book:
threshold.clientsecure.me

It's time to cross your threshold.

#ACLprevention #athletictraining
#strengthandconditioning #footballtraining
#lacrossetraining #returntosport
#sportsphysicaltherapy #eccentrictraining
#kneehealth #athletedevelopment

Personalize this

- Which of your football or lacrosse athletes tested with the weakest deceleration or "brakes," and what single-leg or eccentric work did you program to fix it?
- Walk through an actual return-to-sport call you made on an ACL athlete: what hop-test symmetry, single-leg strength, and movement-quality markers did you want before clearing them to cut?
- How does "train the lowering" eccentric thinking show up in the CROSS framework you build, and where do active

adults (stairs, stepping off curbs) fit as the secondary story?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10305302/> | "Effects of Eccentric-Oriented Strength Training on Return to Sport Criteria in Late-Stage Anterior Cruciate Ligament (ACL)-Reconstructed Professional Team Sport Players"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10305302/> | "Significant group-by-time interactions were found for ISOSU ($p < 0.05$, ES = 2.51, very large), ISOSI ($p < 0.05$, ES = 1.78, large), CMJ ($p < 0.05$, ES = 2.23, very large), SLJI ($p < 0.05$, ES = 1.48, large), SLHI ($p < 0.05$, ES = 1.83, large), and TLHI ($p < 0.05$, ES = 1.83, large)."
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10305302/> | "It seems that flywheel strength training can be recommended in late-stage ACL recovery for professional team sport athletes in order to regain recommended

performance outcome levels faster."

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10305302/>
- <https://www.mdpi.com/1648-9144/59/6/1111>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. The whole "never static stretch before you compete, it kills your power" rule is mostly wrong, and coaches have been repeating it for 20 years.

Here's where it came from. Studies showed that if you hold a long static stretch and then immediately test maximal strength by itself, force drops. Real effect, and a big one once the stretch goes past 60 seconds.

But here's the part that matters for an athlete. A big meta-analysis just revisited all of it, and when they looked at actual performance, jumping, sprinting, change of direction, that deficit basically disappeared. The authors flat out said their results do not support the old advice to pull static stretching out of warm-ups before

jumping or sprinting.

So what do I tell my guys. Don't hang in a 90-second hamstring stretch right before kickoff, that's still not how I'd warm up. But a few short stretches on a tight spot, 20 or 30 seconds, inside a warm-up that also has movement and build-up sprints, that's totally fine. It won't cost you a step.

A good warm-up is what protects your first hard cut. Get the heart rate up, move through the ranges you're about to use, hit a couple of build-up sprints, and yeah, stretch the cranky spot if you want to.

Does that make sense? The science moved on. A lot of sidelines haven't.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: "Never static stretch before you play, it kills your power" is a myth coaches have repeated for 20 years.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. The whole "never static stretch before you compete, it kills your power" rule is mostly wrong, and coaches have been repeating it for 20 years.

Here's where it came from. Studies showed that if you hold a long static stretch and then immediately test maximal strength by itself, force drops. Real effect, and a big one once the stretch goes past 60 seconds.

But here's the part that matters for an athlete. A big meta-analysis just revisited all of it, and when they looked at actual performance, jumping, sprinting, change of direction, that deficit basically disappeared. The authors flat out said their results do not support the old advice to pull static stretching out of warm-ups before jumping or sprinting.

So what do I tell my guys. Don't hang in a 90-second hamstring stretch right before kickoff, that's still not how I'd warm up. But a few short stretches on a tight spot, 20 or 30 seconds, inside a warm-up that also has movement and build-up sprints, that's totally fine. It won't cost you a step.

A good warm-up is what protects your first hard cut. Get the heart rate up, move through the ranges you're about to use, hit a couple of build-up sprints, and yeah, stretch the cranky spot if you want to.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 "Never stretch before you play" is a myth
- 0:10 Old finding: long stretch lowers max strength (in isolation)
- 0:26 New meta: jumping/sprinting deficit disappears
- 0:40 Authors: don't pull stretching from warm-ups
- 0:52 Skip the 90-sec hang before kickoff
- 1:00 Short stretches inside a real warm-up = fine
- 1:10 Warm up well, stop fearing the stretch

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Hot take: the rule that you should never static stretch before you compete because it kills your power is mostly wrong, and it's been repeated on sidelines for 20 years.

The fear came from real studies. Hold a long static stretch, then test maximal strength in isolation, and force drops, especially past 60 seconds per stretch. A recent meta-analysis revisited all of it and found that when you measure actual athletic performance, jumping, sprinting, change of direction, that deficit basically disappears. The authors wrote that their results do not support previous recommendations to exclude static stretching from warm-ups before jumping or sprinting.

What I tell my football and lacrosse athletes: don't hang in a 90-second hamstring stretch right before kickoff, but 20 to 30 seconds on a genuinely tight spot inside a full warm-up (movement prep plus build-up sprints) won't cost you a step. The warm-up is what protects your first hard cut. The science moved on. A lot of sidelines haven't.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT Book:
threshold.clientsecure.me

It's time to cross your threshold.

#warmup #staticstretching #sportsscience
#footballtraining #lacrossetraining
#strengthandconditioning #athletictraining
#mobility #coachingtips
#sportsphysicaltherapy

Personalize this

- What does your actual pre-practice warm-up look like for your HS football or lacrosse athletes, and where (if anywhere) does static stretching fit it right now?
- Have you had a coach or athlete push back on stretching before competition, and how did you handle the "it kills your power" claim on the spot?
- Is there an athlete you've cleared who has one chronically tight spot (hip flexor, hamstring) where a short pre-game static stretch actually helps them move, and how do you coach that without it turning into a 90-second hang?

Screenshots:

- title |
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/38735533/>
| "Revisiting the stretch-induced force deficit: A systematic review with multilevel meta-analysis of acute effects"
- physiology |
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/38735533/>
| "with high magnitude ES (ES = -0.84, $p = 0.004$) for stretching durations ≥ 60 s per bout when compared to passive controls."
- actionable |
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/38735533/>
| "since no (or even positive) effects could be found for athletic performance, our results do not support previous recommendations to exclude static stretching from warm-up routines prior to, for example, jumping or sprinting."

Sources:

- <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/38735533/>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11336295/>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- In-season velocity-based training: VL15 (stop the set at 15% bar-speed loss) beat traditional and VL30 for change-of-direction and reactive strength in youth soccer.
- Isometric holds for jumper's knee (patellar tendinopathy): isometric and isotonic both cut pain in-season without dropping training load.
- Deceleration as a trainable, testable skill on its own (sprint-to-stop drills, braking mechanics).

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (2026-06-24): only 1 source, a Dr. Mercola promo email (strong immune system, marine oil for liver fat, hot lemon water). All promotional, nothing clinically usable. Skipped.
- PubMed / S&C scan (athlete-biased): deceleration + eccentric strength for ACL prevention (multiple), velocity-based in-season training (elite youth soccer,

female athletes), isometric vs isotonic for patellar tendinopathy in-season, acute static stretching meta-analyses.

- Picked: (A) eccentric-oriented strength training for ACL return-to-sport durability (Stojanović et al., Medicina 2023); (B) the acute static-stretching-in-warmups meta-analysis (Behm/Konrad et al., J Sport Health Sci 2024).
- Runners-up held for later: in-season velocity-based training (VL15 superior for change-of-direction in youth soccer); isometric holds for jumper's knee in-season.
- Dedup: both primary URLs checked against cited-sources.json — neither present. ACL is a recent topic family (06-23 lower-limb strength / Nordic), but this is a distinct mechanism angle (eccentric/deceleration) from a fresh source, which the registry allows.